

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K 10

♣ A 9 8 2



♠ 9 5 3

♥ 9 8 7 2

♦ 8 6 5 3

♣ K 6

♠ K 7 4

♥ A J 10

♦ Q J 4

♣ Q J 10 7

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥9

[showcards N:S4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. North's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, South has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore East must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that East **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since East will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

North has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠10 and made the slam.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

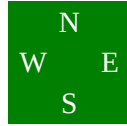
♠ K J 5
 ♥ Q 7 4
 ♦ 10 7 2
 ♣ A J 9 5

♠ 7 6 3

♥ K J 10

♦ K J 9 6

♣ 10 7 2



♠ A Q 4

♥ A 8 5

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ 8 6 3

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ 9 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ K Q 4

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠ 10

again establish 3 ♣ winners. But East's correct play would be to put on dummy's ♣ 9, finessing South for the ♣ 10. This is because ♣ K 10 **or** ♣ Q 10 are twice as likely as ♣ K Q.

[showcards S:C3]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠ 10; low cards from West and North, won by East with the ♠ A.

East next plays the ♣ 3 and you must decide whether to split your ♣ K Q.

Play the ♣ 4.

If you split your Honors, playing the ♣ Q perhaps, dummy's ♣ A will take the trick and East will later play through your ♣ K toward dummy's ♣ J 9 5. Played in this way he will establish 3 ♣ winners (which he needs for the contract).

If you play low, he **MIGHT** finesse the ♣ J and

If he does play this way North will win the ♣ 10 and your ♣ K Q will get one more trick.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 7 3

♥ 10

♦ J 10 9 8 5 2

♣ Q 5

♠ A K 9 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ A Q 4

♣ 10 8 6



♠ 10 6 2

♥ 7 3

♦ K 7 6 3

♣ A 9 4 2

♠ Q 5

♥ A J 9 8 5 4 2

♦ -

♣ K J 7 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

6 ♥

All Pass

6 ♥ by South

Lead: ♦ J

have been ♣s, and he has discarded 2 of them.

[showcards W:DJ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown, (wild).

Partner led the ♦ J; ♦ Q from dummy, ♦ K from you and ruffed by South.

South then pulls two rounds of trumps, (West discards on the second one), followed by his ♠ Q, dummy's ♠ A K and dummy's ♦ A. South discards ♣s on the last two cards.

The ♣ 6 is then played from dummy and you must make a decision - ♣ A or ♣ 2?

Play the ♣ 2.

You have a full count on South's hand. He started with 2 ♠s, 7 ♥s, and no ♦s. His other 4 cards must

So he has 2 ♣s left in his hand. If one of them is the ♣ K and you play your ♣ A then you have handed him the contract.

By playing low you give him a guess to make. If he plays the ♣ K he will make the contract, but if he plays the ♣ J he will go down. He will probably play the ♣ J, figuring you wouldn't have the nerve to duck with the ♣ A. He'll know better next time he plays against you.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 5
♥ 9 3
♦ A K Q
♣ K 9 7 5 2

♠ K Q 4

♥ 7 4

♦ J 9 7 5 4

♣ A J 3



♠ 8 6 2

♥ A K Q J 10

♦ 8 3

♣ Q 10 6

♠ A 10 7 3

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ 10 6 2

♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
1♣	Pass	1♥	Pass
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West

Lead: ♦ 5

DOES have this card; otherwise West has his 9 tricks.

[showcards S:C9]

You are North. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♦ 5; ♦ 3, ♦ 10 and won by West with
♦ K. West now leads the ♣ 9 from his hand

Play the ♣ A.

First ask yourself "Where are the ♦ A and
♦ Q?" South doesn't have either one or he would have
played it at the first trick. So West has both of them.
So with those 3 tricks and the 5 ♥s in dummy West
only needs to find one more winner. Assuming he
has the ♣ K, (or why play the suit), if you play low
he will find that one more winner whichever high ♣
he plays.

Next ask yourself "Where is the ♠ A?" Clearly South

So the way to beat the contract is to go up with your ♣ A, then play ♠ K, ♠ Q and a third ♠, hoping South
holds ♠ A x x x.